If you request an extension of an ongoing course of treatment at least 24 hours prior to the expiration of the approved time period and this is also an urgent care claim, we will make a decision within 24 hours after we receive the claim.

- **Emergency inpatient admission**

If you have an emergency admission due to a condition that you reasonably believe puts your life in danger or could cause serious damage to bodily function, you, your representative, the physician, or the facility must notify us within two business days following the day of the emergency admission, even if you have been discharged from the facility.

- **Maternity care**

You do not need precertification of a maternity admission for a routine delivery. However, if your medical condition requires you to stay more than 48 hours after a vaginal delivery or 96 hours after a cesarean section, then your physician or the facility must contact us for precertification of additional days. Further, if your baby stays after you are discharged, your physician or the facility must contact us for precertification of additional days for your baby.

Note: When a newborn requires definitive treatment during or after the mother's stay, the newborn is considered a patient in their own right. If the newborn is eligible for coverage, regular medical or surgical benefits apply rather than maternity benefits.

- **If your facility stay needs to be extended**

If your facility stay - including for maternity care - needs to be extended, you, your representative, your doctor or the facility must ask us to approve the additional days. If you remain in the facility beyond the number of days we approved and did not get the additional days precertified, then:

- for the part of the admission that was medically necessary, we will pay inpatient benefits, but,
- for the part of the admission that was not medically necessary, we will pay only medical services and supplies otherwise payable on an outpatient basis and will not pay inpatient benefits.

- **Other services that require preauthorization**

Some surgeries, procedures, services and equipment require precertification or preauthorization such as, but not limited to, the following list. Please note this list is subject to change, please call to verify if your procedure requires preauthorization. Refer to the back of your member ID card under the heading Prior Authorization for the contact information.

Services requiring preauthorization or medical necessity determination may be reviewed with guidelines as described at geha.com/Coverage-Criteria. G.E.H.A has coverage policies for many services and procedures; refer to geha.com/Provider-Policies for a complete list of policies.

- Advanced wound therapy including negative pressure therapy/wound vac;
- Applied behavioral analysis (ABA) therapy;
- Arthroplasty, including revisions to a prior arthroplasty;
- Certain back and spinal surgeries, and pain management treatments;
- Bariatric and metabolic surgical procedures (obesity surgery);
- Bone growth stimulators;
- Certain breast and chest surgeries;
- Certain cardiac and vascular procedures;
- Cartilage implants;
- Cellular and gene therapy;
- Certain prescription drugs, including but not limited to:
  - Artificial insemination (AI) drugs and IVF-related drugs
  - Botox injections
  - Chemotherapy drugs
  - Growth hormone therapy (GHT)
  - Injectable drugs for arthritis, psoriasis or hepatitis